

begins by singing various platitudes and trivial facts, which being heard with scorn by Wäinämöinen, he takes a higher tone, and haughtily asserts that he was one of the creators of the universe. Indignant at this falsehood, and contemptuously refusing a challenge to fight with swords, Wäinämöinen sings in his turn, and to such purpose that Joukahainen gradually sinks into the earth, while his sledge and his garments are subjected to the most fantastic transformations. In this predicament, the rash youth attempts to regain his liberty by successively offering to Wäinämöinen a pair of marvellous bows, a couple of useful messengers, two horses, caps full of gold and silver, quantities of corn; but all in vain, as the conqueror asserts he has enough of such possessions already. When, however, Joukahainen at last offers his sister Aino, Wäinämöinen, delighted at the prospect of obtaining so fair a wife, at once releases him, and he goes home in very desponding condition to his parents. His sister is equally grieved at the thought of leaving her father's home; but the old woman, his mother, is rejoiced that she will obtain a son-in-law of such renown.

Aino's dislike of old Wäinämöinen (he is called "old" even before his birth) is increased by some gullant speeches with which he accosts her, while she is gathering branches in a wood for the purpose of making brooms. She runs home in an agony of grief, in which her mother does not at all participate; but, on the contrary, advises her to make herself as smart as possible, and in particular to put on certain golden girdles and blue gowns that were made by the Daughter of the Moon, from whom in her youth she received them as a gift. Aino refuses to be consoled, but puts on the fine clothes, and flies from home to avoid the hateful marriage. On the third day after her flight, while she is lamenting on the sea-shore, and preparing to take a bath, a stone on which she attempts to sit rolls into the water, and she sinks with it, bemoaning her own untimely end. Various animals perceive the accident; but neither the bear, the wolf, nor the fox will quit their usual occupations to carry the bad news to her parents. The melancholy office is performed by the hare; and such is the remorseful grief of Aino's mother, who justly regards herself as the cause of her daughter's decease, that she not only weeps so violently as to wet through all her garments, but her tears form three great rivers. In every one of the rivers is a cataract, and in each of these is a hill upon which stands a birch-tree, on the top of which three cuckoos are singing.

As for Wäinämöinen, he no sooner hears the fate of Aino than he resolves to recover her, and calls upon an obscure dreaming deity (a sort of Morpheus), named Untamo, to show the abode of the water-goddesses. A certain woody island is indicated, to which Wäinämöinen at once proceeds in a boat, and commences angling in the ordinary fashion. Soon he hooks the most beautiful fish he has ever seen in his life, and prepares to cut it up with his knife; when it leaps back into the water, and reproaching him for his want of discernment, confesses that it is Joukahainen's sister, who, in altered mood, had come to be his wife, but is now lost to him for ever. Wäinämöinen is overwhelmed with grief, less perhaps at the loss of the